



1.d) Matrilineal Puzzle

Matrilineality refers to a form of descent in which inheritance and succession passes through the female line.

(e.g.) Khasis, Niyars.

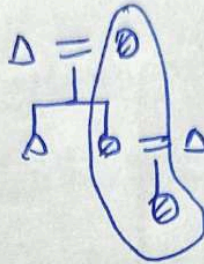


Fig. 1) Matrilineal descent.

Matrilineal people refers to the situation in matrilineal groups where the locus of authority is different than the commonly assumed ~~matr~~ matrilineal.

→ In many matrilineal societies, the authority rests with the maternal uncle or brother of woman.

(e.g.) Masais.

→ This leads to a contradiction b/w the descent and type of authority.

Consequences

1) Dilemma of man (maternal uncle) as to give more attention to his own children or sisters.

given by Audrey Richards
↓
He describes the challenging role of man in matrilineal society.

Challenges done
do not write anything in this Area

- 2) Man has only authority while dealing with external world but has no access to resources in family
- 3) Have to bear the various miseries of sister's children.

Also, in various matrilineal societies, another contradiction observed in respect of rules of residence.

→ Matrilineal societies can have various forms of residence -

- a) Bilocal → Residence keeps shifting.
- b) Matrilineal → Residence initially matrilineal but later patrilineal
- c) Avenueal → Residence at maternal uncle's place

Matrilineality is thus, juggling as rules of anti-descent contrast with rules of authority and residence.

Maybe this is a reason why societies that are matrilineal have changed to patrilineal.

Criticisms → Eurocentric view of family.
→ Colonial influence.

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